

QUICK FIXES FOR YOUR PC

Your answer to the most common computer ailments as well as tips on how to increase productivity and enhance the entire computing experience

Like it or not, PC troubleshooting has always been part and parcel of the overall computing experience. A major hurdle with PC troubleshooting in India has been the paucity of professional call centres and guidance from expert solution providers. Even if someone is there to help, the experience can prove to be frustrating, expensive and sometimes of no practical use.

The sheer variety and gamut of peripherals available today means that tracking down the root of the cause is always time-consuming and exasperating. Little wonder then that solutions from most dealers and so-called experts tend to be catastrophic—“you will have to change everything here” or “nothing can be done at all.”

The good news is that almost 90 per cent of all PC-related

problems are easily solvable and you needn't pick up the screwdriver every time you want to troubleshoot. All you need to apply is a little common sense and track down the source of the problem. Once you've tracked the problem, the solution rarely involves any major system overhaul.

PCs are like individuals with varying characteristics and behavioural patterns. Only those users who really use their PCs can observe the quirks and performance oddities peculiar to their PC. The ability to diagnose these faults takes a little experience (and time) and this is where the Troubleshooting Guide steps in: to help you find easy solutions to common problems as well as long-drawn 'if and then' solutions for complicated and confusing problems. All you need is an open mind and a desire to troubleshoot. Ready?

MODEM & INTERNET

No connection

Q My modem handshakes but it refuses to connect. What could be the problem?

A There can be several reasons for this. The most prominent reason is usually the slow response from the local and remote server. Line noise (disturbance) can also hamper the connection between your modem and the modem used by the ISP.

Lower the connecting speeds—this will

make you log on to the Net at lower speeds and take care of the problem. To set the modem speeds, go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > System > Device Manager**, right-click on Modem and click on Properties. In the window which opens up, click on the Modem tab and under 'Maximum port speed', select the slowest speed (300 bits per second).

Slow transfer rates

Q I have a 33.6 kbps modem but it still has slow transfer rates. How do I fix this?

A Internet speed depends on many factors such as the speed of your modem, the condition of the telephone line and bandwidth provided by the ISP. If you want faster transfer rates, go in for a 56.6 Kbps modem.

Make sure your telephone line is properly wired. If you still feel the rates are not fast enough, then the fault lies with the telephone which is not capable of supporting more than 6 kbps transfer rates. In that case the only alternative left is either a DSL or a cable connection.